

Technical Screening

Estimated time needed: 5 minutes

Introduction

If you are planning to be part of the IT industry, chances are that you will have a technical screening or interview stage. Technical screening is the process of assessing the technical capabilities and skill levels of a candidate.

Objectives

After completing this reading, you will be able to:

- Explain the purpose of a technical screening
- List questions that you may be asked during the technical screening

Technical screening defined

A technical screening or interview is often used to gauge a candidate's relative technical skills for a job.

Typically, technical screening or interview is used when evaluating candidates for roles in Information Technology, Healthcare, Engineering, and Science. However, employers might decide to conduct a technical screening to determine a candidate's knowledge for a variety of different specialties to include project management, product management, marketing, human resources, or education or hospitality.

Companies look for candidates who can articulate industry terms and concepts that relate to the position they are seeking to fill. Technical screening allows employers to determine if your skills and technical knowledge qualify you for the open job position. Learning more about technical screening interviews and how to present yourself can enhance your professionalism and your chances of landing the job.

Note: In some organizations, there may be two or more technical rounds: the first might be a technical screening where the candidate might need to complete a written test followed by a virtual or face-to-face interview.

Typical cybersecurity technical screening or interview questions

A key technical screening or interview preparation step is to research potential questions before your screening interview to help you prepare to respond to those questions effectively. This is your opportunity to showcase the technical knowledge that you can bring to the job. The ultimate goal you should seek is to stand out among all the other candidates and differentiate yourself through your skills.

The table summarizes common questions that project managers might encounter during a technical screening or interview.

Question	Inputs for Potential Response
What is your experience using vulnerability management software?	• Share details about the vulnerability management software that you have used and are proficient in. • May include like Nexpose, OpenVAS, IBM QRadar, and other tools. Match your skills to software mentioned in the job description if possible.
How do you manage and mitigate cybersecurity vulnerabilities and threats?	• Provide your understanding of the differences between vulnerabilities and threats. • Share methods used for vulnerability management and response to threats.
What is your experience with cybersecurity frameworks and standards?	• Discuss familiarity with cybersecurity frameworks (for example, NIST and ISO 27001) and standards. • Explain how you implemented cybersecurity frameworks in previous roles.
Have you worked with incident response and how do you handle incidents?	• Share your experience with incident response procedures. • Discuss how you identify, contain, eradicate, recover, and learn from security incidents.
What is your experience with penetration testing and ethical hacking?	• Discuss your experience with penetration testing tools and methodologies. • Explain how you conducted ethical hacking to identify and remediate security weaknesses.
How do you stay updated on the latest cybersecurity threats and trends?	• Describe methods for staying informed about emerging threats and industry trends. • Mention any certifications, training, or communities you actively participate in.
What is your experience with security risk assessments?	• Share experience in conducting security risk assessments. • Discuss how you identify, evaluate, and prioritize risks and develop mitigation strategies.

Have you implemented security awareness training programs?	• Discuss experience in developing and implementing security awareness training programs. • Highlight any improvements in employee awareness and behavior.
How do you ensure compliance with cybersecurity regulations?	• Explain your approach to ensuring compliance with relevant cybersecurity regulations. • Discuss any experience with audits and regulatory assessments.
What is your experience with security monitoring and SIEM tools?	• Share experience with security monitoring tools and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) systems. • Discuss how you use them for threat detection.
How do you handle cybersecurity incidents in a cloud environment?	• Share experience with incident response in cloud environments. • Explain how you address unique challenges and integrate cloud security into incident response.

Conclusion

Plan ahead and be ready to share your technical knowledge and skills during the technical screening interview. Show how you are able to satisfy all key aspects of the job you are applying for.

